

OVERVIEW OF OUR 1.5 DAYS TOGETHER

DAY 1

9:00 – 10:00 Session 1: Classroom Management for SLA

10:30 – 12:00 Session 2: Combining SLA Theory with Practice

12:00 – 13:30 lunch

13:30 – 14:50 Session 3: How to Teach Vocabulary Effectively

15:10 – 16:30 Session 4: Grammar Teaching

DAY 2

9:00 – 10:00 Session 5: Language Assessment

10:30 – 12:00 Session 6: AI Role-Play Activities in SLA

12:00 – 12:30 Feedback and Evaluation

6. AI Role-Play Activities in SLA

Margreet Vogelzang



OBJECTIVES



By the end of the session, you will be able to:

- **Understand** speaking skills
- **Identify and apply** criteria for effective speaking activities
- **Learn** more about engaging/active teaching methods, including AI role-play activities

OVERVIEW

- Criteria for a good speaking exercise
- L2 speaking and anxiety
- AI Role-Play Activities



Criteria for a good speaking exercise

For teaching purposes

THINK — PAIR — SHARE



JOIN THE VEVOX SESSION

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Question slide

WRITE AT LEAST 3 CRITERIA FOR A GOOD SPEAKING EXERCISE (DO NOT
WRITE SENTENCES)
YOU MAY SUBMIT ANSWERS SEVERAL TIMES



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Preparing Results

WRITE AT LEAST 3 CRITERIA FOR A GOOD SPEAKING EXERCISE (DO NOT
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RESULTS SLIDE

CRITERIA FOR A GOOD SPEAKING ACTIVITY

- Clear instructions
- The task is communicative
- A clear reason to speak
- The topic is relevant to learners' interests
- There is a goal to achieve
- An information gap
- Two-way information exchange
- Authentic and realistic
- Appropriate to the learners' level

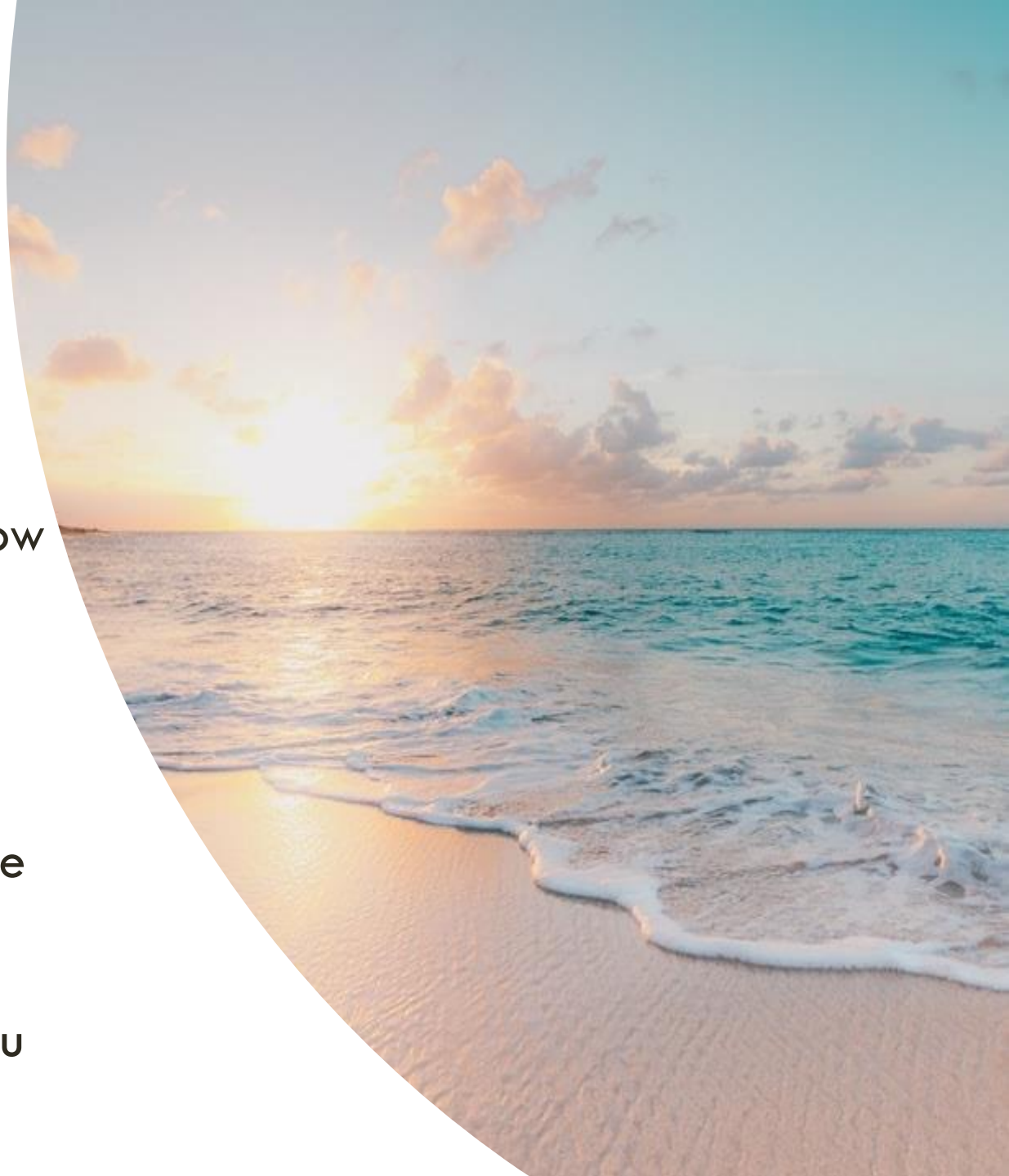
A scenic photograph of a tropical beach at sunset. The sun is low on the horizon, casting a warm, golden glow across the sky and reflecting on the turquoise ocean. Gentle waves with white foam are washing onto the white sand beach in the foreground. The sky is filled with soft, colorful clouds in shades of orange, pink, and blue. On the left side, a small strip of land with palm trees is visible.

Let's test this!
Speaking about travel

EXERCISE — 5 MIN

Work in pairs

- Think of a place you would like to be right now
- Find a photo of this place online using your smartphone or laptop
- Show the photo to your partner
- Your partner guesses why you chose this place
- For example: *“Have you ever been there?”*
- After a few minutes, tell your partner why you chose it



WAS THIS MOTIVATING?
WHY?



HOW COULD WE USE AI?

L2 SPEAKING AND ANXIETY

Phonological control scale (CEFR, 2001: 117)

C2 As C1

C1 Can vary intonation and place sentence stress correctly in order to express finer shades of meaning.

B2 Has acquired a clear, natural, pronunciation and intonation.

B1 Pronunciation is clearly intelligible even if a foreign accent is sometimes evident and occasional mispronunciations occur.

A2 Pronunciation is generally clear enough to be understood despite a noticeable foreign accent, but conversational partners will need to ask for repetition from time to time.

A1 Pronunciation of a very limited repertoire of learnt words and phrases can be understood with some effort by native speakers used to dealing with speakers of his/her language group.

FOREIGN LANGUAGE ANXIETY

Foreign language anxiety is the worry, nervousness or fear learners experience when using or learning a language that is not their first language

- Particularly noticeable during speaking
- Can affect confidence, participation and performance
- Different from general anxiety - it can be specific to the language-learning context

FOREIGN LANGUAGE ANXIETY

Common triggers:

- Speaking in front of others
- Fear of making mistakes
- Fear of being judged by peers/teacher
- Tests and assessment
- Being put on the spot
- Difficulty finding the right words

WHAT CAN TEACHERS DO?

Reduce threat → increase support

- Give thinking/preparation time
- Start with pairs → small groups → whole class
- Allow learners to rehearse before speaking publicly
- Create a classroom where mistakes are normal
- Don't constantly interrupt to correct errors
- Give clear, achievable tasks
- Allow some choice/autonomy
- Use anonymous participation where appropriate

HOW COULD AI HELP?





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Question slide

HOW COULD AI HELP AGAINST FOREIGN LANGUAGE ANXIETY?



##/##

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Preparing Results

HOW COULD AI HELP AGAINST FOREIGN LANGUAGE ANXIETY?

RESULTS SLIDE

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

AI role-play activities are language-learning activities in which learners **interact with an AI system as if it were another person**

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

A learner studying English might tell an AI:

“You are a hotel receptionist. I am a guest who wants to check in. Speak to me in English and ask me questions.”

Receptionist: Good evening! Welcome to the Grand Hotel. How may I help you today?

 Share



I want to check in

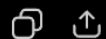
Receptionist: Of course. May I have your name, please? And do you have a reservation with us?



Margreet Vogelzang

Receptionist: Thank you, Ms. Vogelzang. Let me check your reservation.

Could you please confirm **how many nights you'll be staying with us?**



2 nights

Receptionist: Thank you. I have you down for a two-night stay.

May I please see your **passport or ID**, and could you confirm whether you would like **one room key or two?**

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

Different possible real-life settings, e.g.:

Everyday situations

- Ordering food at a restaurant
- Checking into a hotel
- Shopping
- Meeting a new friend

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

Different possible settings, e.g.:

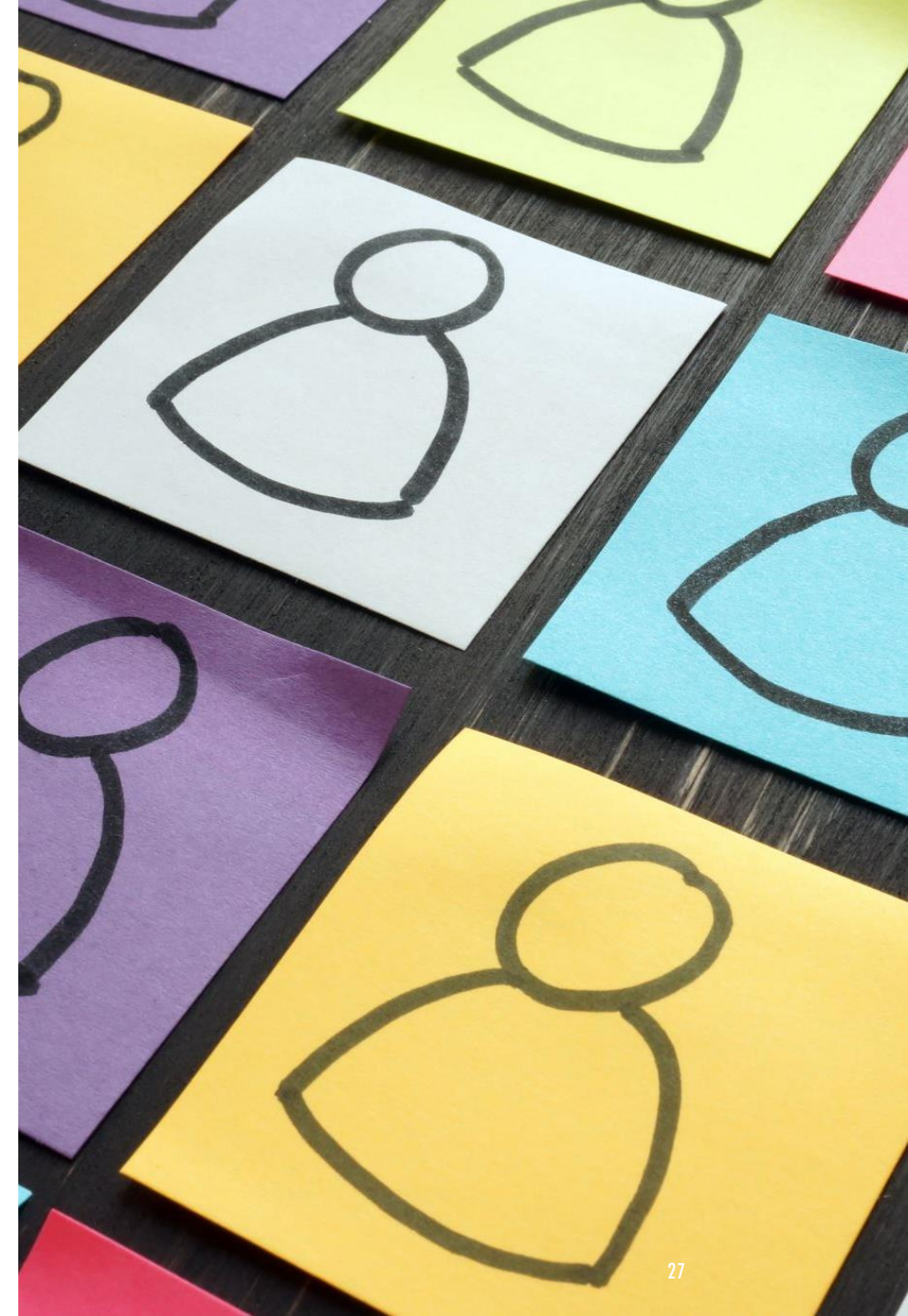
Professional situations (but maybe more relevant for adults)

AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

Can also create a fictional character for children to interact with

Such interactive tasks boost creativity, communication, and critical thinking when guided safely by an adult

Test the activity before doing it live with your students!



INTERVIEW



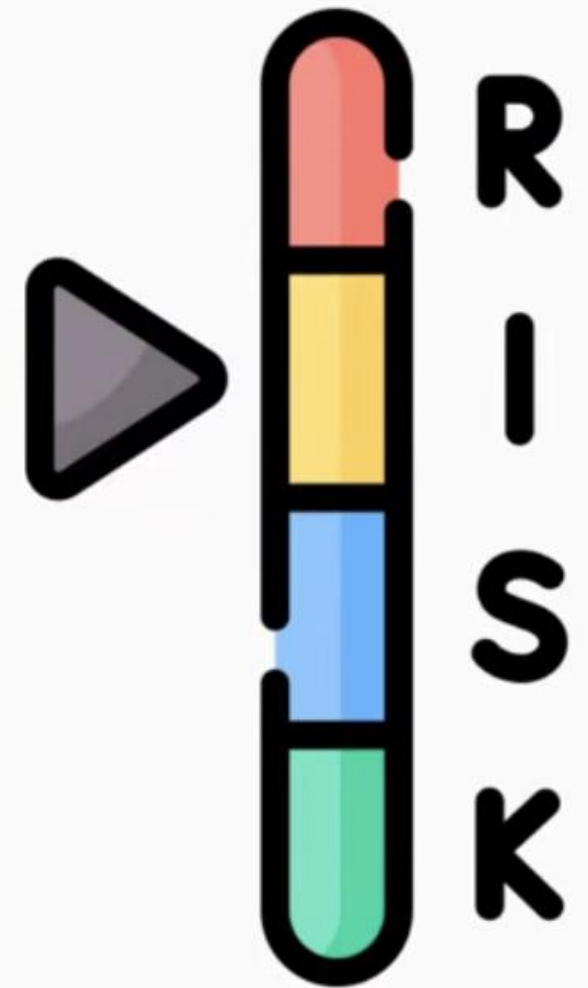
AI ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES

Try it out!

Individual work

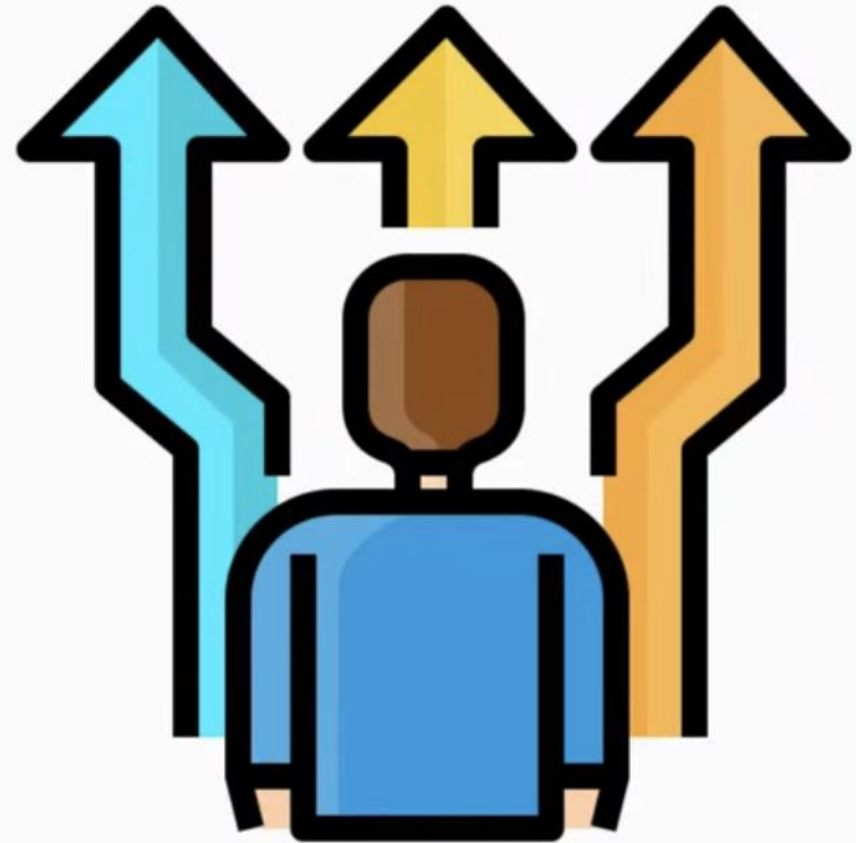
5-10 min

- Test this activity before doing this live with your students to evaluate the AI chatbot you will be using for any possible issues with accuracy or bias (gender, racial, etc.).
- Make it clear to students that the AI is only roleplaying and may respond with incorrect information.
- As a class, evaluate the AI responses for accuracy, bias, relevance, and alignment with known facts.



CHOOSE YOUR OWN ADVENTURE — 10 MIN

- For this activity the students will play a "Choose Your Own Adventure" game with the AI.
- You will provide the AI with a topic, character & key objectives.
- The AI will generate a story with choices for the class to make.



OVERVIEW

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RESOURCES

<https://www.teachingenglish.org.uk/>

<https://www.usingenglish.com/teachers/>